provides the list of price-controlled drugs, procedures for fixation of prices of drugs, method of implementation of prices fixed by government and penalties for contravention of provisions among other things. For the purpose of implementing provisions of DPCO, powers of the government have been vested in the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority. As of now, 74 bulk drugs are under price control and there is no price control on 70 to 75 per cent of the retail pharma market.

Drugs and formulation have been subjected to price control for more than three decades now and the industry's stand is that when price control has been abolished in a large number of industries, it is unfair to stifle the pharmaceutical industry with rigorous price control. While the government has expressed that it wants to provide a stable policy environment to the pharmaceutical industry, it has also said that it will ensure the availability of essential and life-saving drugs at reasonable prices to the public.

DUMPING

Exporting a good at a price lower than its price in the domestic market. To neutralise the effects of dumping the importing country may impose a *surcharge* on such imports which is known as the *anti-dumping duty.*

DUTCH DISEASE

When an increase in one form of net exports drives up a country's exchange rate, it is called the Dutch Disease. Such instances make other exports non-competitive in the world market and impairs the ability of domestic products to compete with imports.

The term originated from the supposed effect of natural gas discoveries on the Netherlands economy.

DUTY DRAWBACK SCHEME